

Social Engineering 2.0



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Traditional social engineering relies on trust, urgency, and manipulation but now, with AI, attackers have supercharged their ability to deceive.



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They're not just sending fake emails—they're using:

- Synthetic voices that sound like your boss
- Deepfake videos that appear to show real people saying things they never said
- Hyper-personalized attacks that are hard to tell from reality



Voice Cloning ... When the Call Sounds Real

AI voice tools can generate realistic audio from just a few seconds of someone's voice (which can be scraped from YouTube, meetings, voicemail, etc.).



Voice Cloning ... When the Call Sounds Real

Real-world scam example:

- An attacker cloned a CEO's voice and called the company's finance director.
- The "CEO" urgently requested a money transfer to a vendor.
- The finance director complied—because the voice was familiar and authoritative.



Deepfake Videos: Seeing Is No Longer Believing

Deepfakes are AI-generated videos that replace someone's face and voice in a realistic way.

They've been used in:

- Corporate impersonations to trick employees during video calls
- Fake video messages sent as phishing bait
- Scams on social media, where public figures endorse fake products



Deepfake Videos: Seeing Is No Longer Believing

Imagine getting a video message that looks and sounds like your manager—but it's entirely fake.



Why These Tactics Work So Well

- People trust voices and faces more than written words.
- Our brains are wired to believe what we see and hear.
- These attacks exploit human psychology even better than traditional phishing.



How to Protect Yourself

- Pause and verify – Always double-check any unusual request, especially if it's about money, credentials, or sensitive data.
- Use multiple channels – If you get a request via call or video, confirm it through a separate method (e.g., email, internal messaging app).



How to Protect Yourself

- Know your company's procedures – Never skip standard protocols, even if the person “sounds urgent.”
- Be skeptical of surprise calls or video links – Especially if the person seems rushed, demanding, or slightly “off.”



Key Takeaway

AI-generated voices and videos are incredibly convincing—and they're already being used in phishing and fraud. Your gut feeling and internal processes are your best protection.

